

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary Fields: Development Economics, Labor Economics.
Secondary Fields: Behavioral and Experimental Economics, Health Economics.

EDUCATION

- University of Michigan 2023–Present
 - Ph.D. Candidate in Economics
- University of Michigan 2025
 - M.A. in Economics (Pathway to Ph.D.)
- Pontifical Catholic University of Peru (PUCP) 2013–2018
 - B.Sc. in Economics

WORK EXPERIENCE

- University of Michigan 2024–2025
 - Research Assistant
 - Supervisor: Emma Riley. Project on adolescent girls’ economic and social empowerment in Tanzania (2025).
 - Supervisor: Elisa Maffioli. Projects on malaria vaccines and fake drugs in Africa (2024–2025).
- Duke University 2020–2023
 - Pre-Doctoral Research Fellow
 - Supervisors: Erica Field, Robert Garlick, and Katherine Vyborny. Projects in Peru and Pakistan on health, gender, labor markets, and survey methodology.
- Innovations for Poverty Action 2018–2020
 - Senior Research Associate
 - Peru. Supervisors: Erica Field, Livia Schubiger, and Javier Romero. Projects on health and gender-based violence.
 - Paraguay. Supervisor: Nathan Fiala. Projects on poverty and financial inclusion.

WORKING PAPERS (IN ORDER OF COMPLETENESS)

- Text Messaging for Mental Health Management During the COVID-19 Pandemic.^{*2} With Erica Field, Daniel Hurtado, and Javier Romero.
 - Imprecise Beliefs About Malaria Infection Risk and Vaccine Protection in Ghana (Third-Year Paper).
 - The Political Economy of University Licensing: Evidence from Peru’s Higher Education Reform.^{*2} With Leah Lakdawala, Fabiola Alba, and Diego Mestanza.
 - Human Capital Investment under Immigration Policy: Evidence from STEM OPT.^{*1} With Marcia Ruiz.
 - The Price of Safety: The Effect of Organized-Crime Extortion on Microfirm Outcomes.^{*1} With Gabby Lecaro.
 - Are Insiders or Community Leaders Effective in Identifying Intimate Partner Violence?^{*3} With Erica Field.
- ^{*} Drafts available upon request.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Enhancing Women’s Safety in Public Spaces (Second-Year Proposal): Training Community Volunteers to Reduce Gender-Based Violence in Peru.^{*1} With Marcia Ruiz. Pilot completed, with data collection scheduled for 2026. (AEA RCT Registry: AEARCTR-0019317)
 - Sustaining Public Infrastructure: A Gender-Informed Behavioral Intervention for Housing Maintenance in Peru.^{*1} With Marcia Ruiz and Emily Saavedra. Midline completed, with data collection scheduled for 2026. (AEA RCT Registry: AEARCTR-0019332)
 - Targeting Men to Reduce Domestic Violence: An Evaluation of Men for Equality.^{*3} With Erica Field. Baseline completed, with endline data collection scheduled for 2026.
 - Sustaining Shared Urban Sanitation in Uganda.^{*1} With Marcia Ruiz and Laston Manja. Pilot completed, with data collection scheduled for 2026.
 - The Price of Safety: The Effects of Extortion on Small-Scale Entrepreneurship in Peru.^{*1} With Gabby Lecaro. Pilot completed, with data collection scheduled for 2026.
 - Formal Savings Adoption Among Vulnerable Populations in Colombia: Evidence from a Banca de las Oportunidades Intervention.^{*1} With Tommaso Crosta. Implementation funding secured, with fieldwork preparation underway for 2026.
 - Targeted School Benefits and Student Sorting: Evidence from Peru.^{*1} With Muchin Bazan and Maria Ferro.
 - Providing Real-Time, Accurate Data to Increase Malaria Vaccine Completion Rates in Ghana.^{*3} With Jessica Cohen and Elisa Maffioli. Baseline completed.
- ^{*1} Coauthored with Peer Graduate Students. ^{*2} Coauthored with Faculty and Peer Graduate Students. ^{*3} Coauthored with Faculty.

PRE-PH.D. PUBLICATIONS (INCLUDING PRE-PH.D. SUBMISSIONS)

- Acosta, G., P. Francke, and D. Quispe. 2026. “Effects of Peru’s National School Feeding Program (Qali Warma) on Overweight and Obesity Among Children Aged 36–59 Months.” *Obesities*, 6(3), 25.
- Acosta, G. and P. Francke. 2021. “Impact of the Qali Warma School Feeding Program on Chronic Child Malnutrition.” *Apuntes*.
- Acosta, G. and P. Francke. 2020. “Impact of Micronutrients ‘Sprinkles’ on Chronic Childhood Malnutrition in Peru.” *Revista Médica Herediana*.

POLICY NOTES AND MEDIA

- Acosta, G., E. Field, H. Khan, and K. Vyborny. 2023. *Lockdowns and Learning Outcomes: Insights from 10th Grade Examination Results in Pakistan*. C-19 Notes, PEDL.
- “SVRI Research Grant Partners 2026.” Video presentation, Sexual Violence Research Initiative, July 2026.

RESEARCH GRANTS

Total funding raised for solo-led projects or projects with peer graduate students: USD \$237,000.
Total funding received, including faculty coauthors: USD \$1,746,000.

- **Street Harassment in Peru (USD \$132,500).** Sexual Violence Research Initiative (SVRI), Lead PI, with Marcia Ruiz and Pedro Francke — USD \$100,000 (2026); The Weiss Fund — USD \$25,000 (2025); U-M PACLSHR Grant — USD \$6,000 (2025); Rackham Research Grant — USD \$1,500 (2025).
- **Extortion in Peru (USD \$4,000).** U-M Economics Research Grant, MPI, with Gabby Lecaro — USD \$2,500 (2026); Rackham Research Grant, MPI, with Gabby Lecaro — USD \$1,500 (2025).
- **Targeting Men to Reduce Domestic Violence: An Evaluation of Men for Equality (USD \$90,000).** Government of Peru Grant (via IPA Peru), MPI, with Erica Field — USD \$90,000 (2026).
- **Sustaining Shared Urban Sanitation in Uganda (USD \$68,500).** Marshall Weinberg Fellowship (U-M ISR), MPI, with Marcia Ruiz and Laston Manja — USD \$8,500 (2026); U-M African Studies Center Research Grant, MPI, with Marcia Ruiz and Laston Manja — USD \$3,000 (2026); PSC Small Grant in Population Research, Pathway to NIH (Freedman and Mueller Funds), MPI, with Marcia Ruiz and Laston Manja — USD \$28,500 (2026); IGC Research Grant, MPI, with Marcia Ruiz and Laston Manja — USD \$28,500 (2025).
- **Sustaining Public Infrastructure in Peru (USD \$20,000).** SYLFF Research Grant, Lead PI, with Marcia Ruiz — USD \$10,000 (2025); Marshall Weinberg Fellowship (U-M ISR), Lead PI, with Marcia Ruiz — USD \$8,500 (2025); Rackham Research Grant, MPI, with Marcia Ruiz — USD \$1,500 (2025).
- **Ghana Malaria Vaccine Adherence RCT (USD \$1,419,000).** Global Development Incubator Grant, Co-Investigator, with Jessica Cohen and Elisa Maffioli — USD \$1,220,000 (2025); The Weiss Fund, Co-Investigator, with Jessica Cohen and Elisa Maffioli — USD \$199,000 (2025).

Pre-Ph.D. Grants and Awards. CIES/USAID Research Grant, *Peruvian Public Health System: A Machine Learning Approach*, MPI, with Pedro Francke — USD \$5,000 (2020); INEI Research Grant, *The Effects of Social Programs on Malnutrition* — USD \$7,000 (2019); SBS Advanced Economics Program Scholarship (2018); PUCP Economics Thesis Competition, First Place (2018); ANU International Exchange Scholarship — AUD \$5,000 (2017).

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

- U-M Economics Graduate Travel Award — USD \$1,400 (May 2026).
- Rackham Graduate Travel Award — USD \$1,200 (2026).
- MCIDT Fellowship and Travel Grant — USD \$1,750 (May 2026).
- National Association for Business Economics (NABE) Scholars Program, 2026–27 cohort — travel stipend of USD \$400 (2026).

INVITED SEMINARS AND CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (INCLUDED SCHEDULED)

- **2027.** ASSA/AEA 2027 Annual Meeting.
- **2026.** Southern Economic Association 96th Annual Meeting; LACEA-LAMES 2026 Annual Meeting; 10th Annual NABE Tech Economics Conference & Industry Job Fair; 68th NABE Annual Meeting; Arnold Ventures BRIDGE Event on Public Safety Challenges for Agencies; SVRI Grantee Workshop; Financial Literacy Research Boot Camp; 21st Australasian Development Economics Workshop; RIDGE Conference; Arnold Ventures BRIDGE Event on Online Harassment and Stalking; Midwest Economics Association Conference.
- **2025.** University of Ghana School of Public Health Seminar.

Pre-Ph.D. Presentations. Empirical Study of Gender (EGEN) Pakistan Workshop II (2022); Duke DevLab Seminar (2021); CIES Annual Research Seminar (2020); [Presentation to Peru’s Minister of Women](#) (2020).

CURRENT COLLABORATIONS

- **Peru:** Ministry of Women and Vulnerable Populations (2018–Present); Ministry of Housing, Construction, and Sanitation (2024–Present); Ministry of Transport and Communications (2025–Present); AJE Group, a Peruvian multinational beverage company (2025–Present).
- **Ghana:** Ghana Health Services (2025–Present).
- **Uganda:** Ministry of Lands, Housing and Urban Development (2025–Present); Ministry of Health (2026–Present); Kampala Capital City Authority (2025–Present).
- **Colombia:** Banca de las Oportunidades (2026–Present).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- **University of Michigan**
 - *Graduate Student Instructor, Economics 101* 2024–2026
- **Pontifical Catholic University of Peru**
 - *Adjunct Professor, Thesis Seminar I* 2026
- **Pontifical Catholic University of Peru**
 - *Teaching Assistant, Macroeconomics* 2018

OTHER INFORMATION

- **Technical Skills:** *Software & programming:* Stata, R, Python, Julia, MATLAB, SQL, Bash, Git, Linux, L^AT_EX, SPSS, Xpress-Mosel, Tableau, web technologies, APIs, ETL, high-performance computing, cloud platforms (AWS); *survey, experimental & geospatial tools:* SurveyCTO, ODK, Qualtrics, oTree, GIS; *ML & AI:* supervised learning, unsupervised learning, NLP, LLMs, agentic workflows, Model Context Protocol (MCP).
- **Languages:** Spanish (native), English (professional proficiency), Chinese (basic proficiency)